

The Roman Republic

1. Founding of the Republic

In 509 BC the Romans expelled their last king and founded a republic. Power was shared so that no single ruler could become a tyrant again.

2. Consuls and the Senate

Two consuls were elected each year to lead the government and army. The Senate, made of former magistrates, advised the consuls on law, finance and foreign policy. Its advice carried great authority.

3. The Assemblies and the Tribunes

Citizens voted in assemblies that elected magistrates and passed laws. Tribunes of the plebs could veto actions that harmed ordinary citizens.